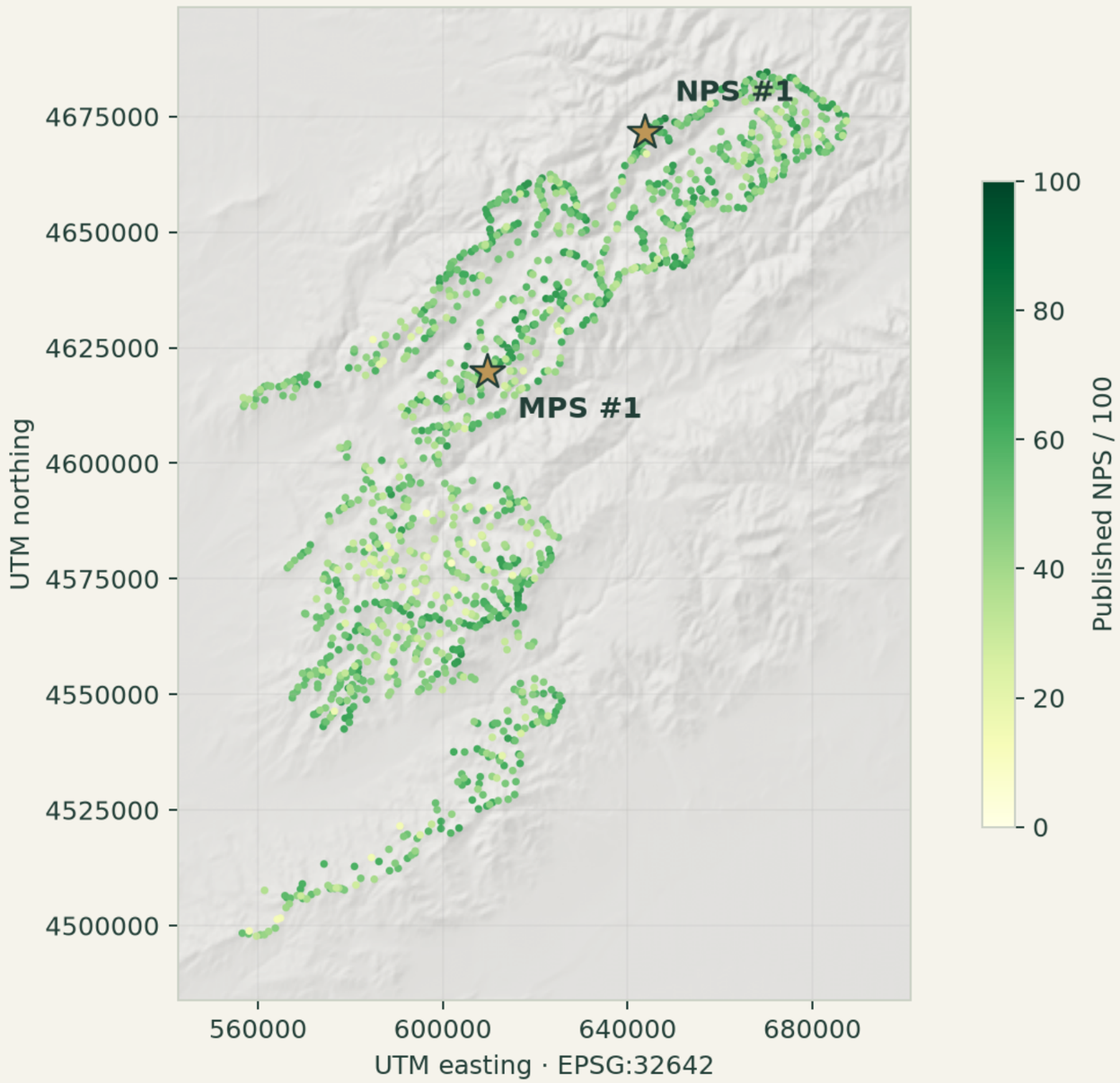
Beyond the Summit

Where are the best mountain views? An exploratory ranking of the same 1,302 summits used in Days 01–04.



Map: published NPS. Stars mark the NPS and MPS winners. Shaded relief is a preview backdrop.

THE BIG PICTURE

Higher is not automatically better. Terrain, visible peaks, skyline shape and distance tell different parts of the story.

NATURAL #1

node:1544318728

NPS 74.72 / 100 · 4,112 m

MOUNTAINEERING #1

Замок / Zamok

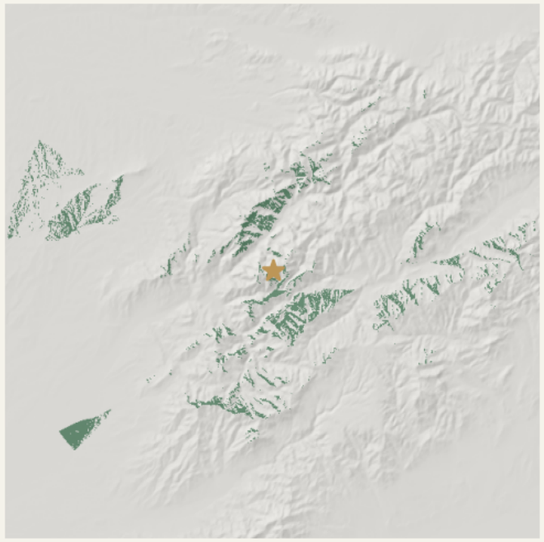
MPS 67.48 · 12 / 15 Horizon targets

- 100 km projected radius; 30 m terrain.
- Elevation–NPS Spearman correlation: 0.329.
- The highest summit ranks 729th in NPS.
- The top two NPS scores differ by only 0.029.

The anatomy of a panorama

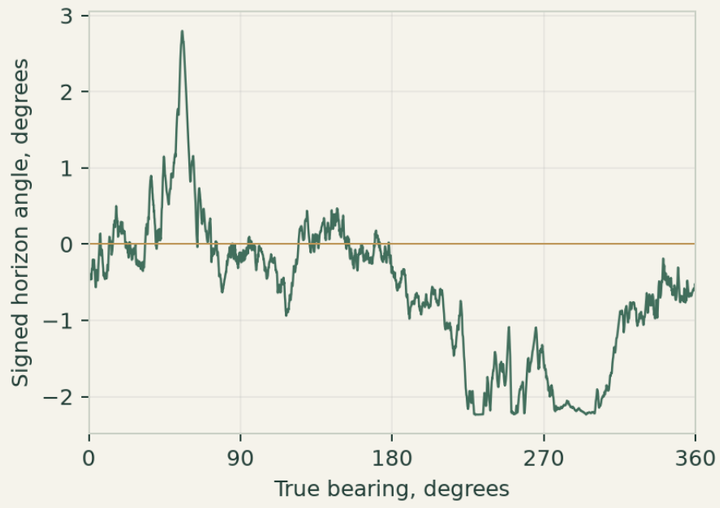
Example: Zamok, the published MPS winner. Ground visibility is a modelled proxy, not a field observation.

01 Visible terrain



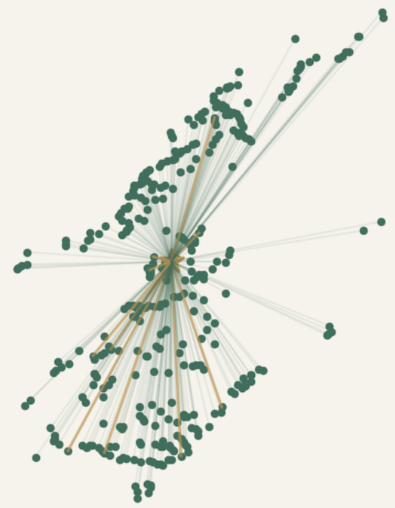
Green: visible ground cells. Display raster is reduced; analysis remains 30 m.

02 The skyline



Signed elevation angle across true bearing. Source profile: 0.1° angular intervals.

03 Visibility connections



All visible peak-ground proxies. Gold lines identify visible Horizon landmarks.

NPS = .30 T + .25 P + .30 S + .15 D

T: visible terrain area and open directions. P: peak count and bearing coverage. S: multiscale angular skyline contrast and complexity. D: terrain depth and peak angular relief. Components use fixed G5 cohort normalization.

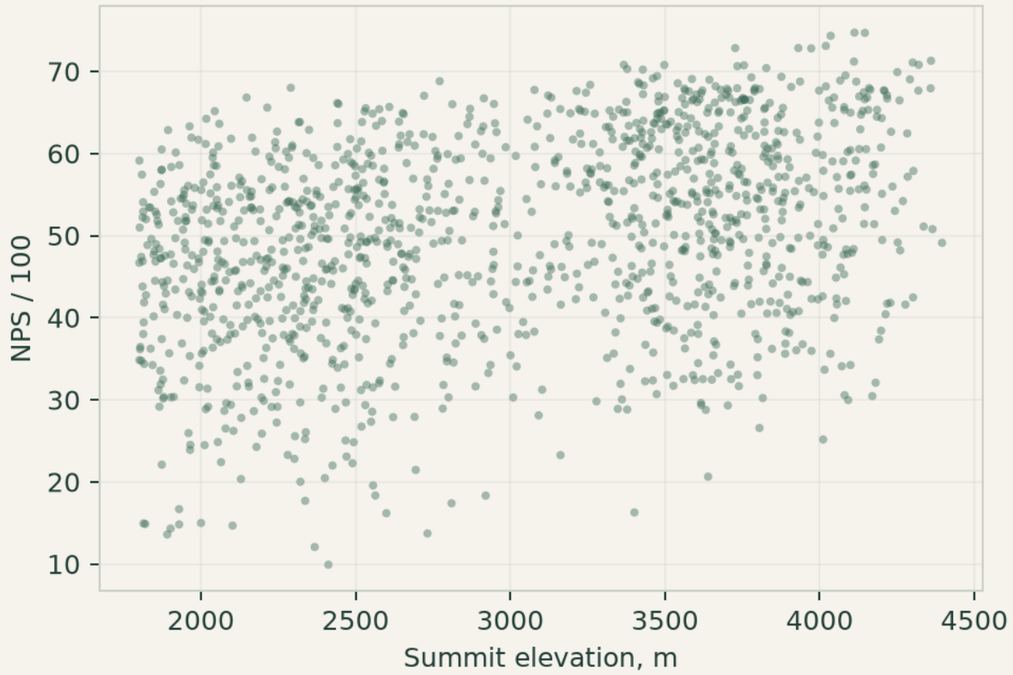
MPS = .80 NPS + .20 L

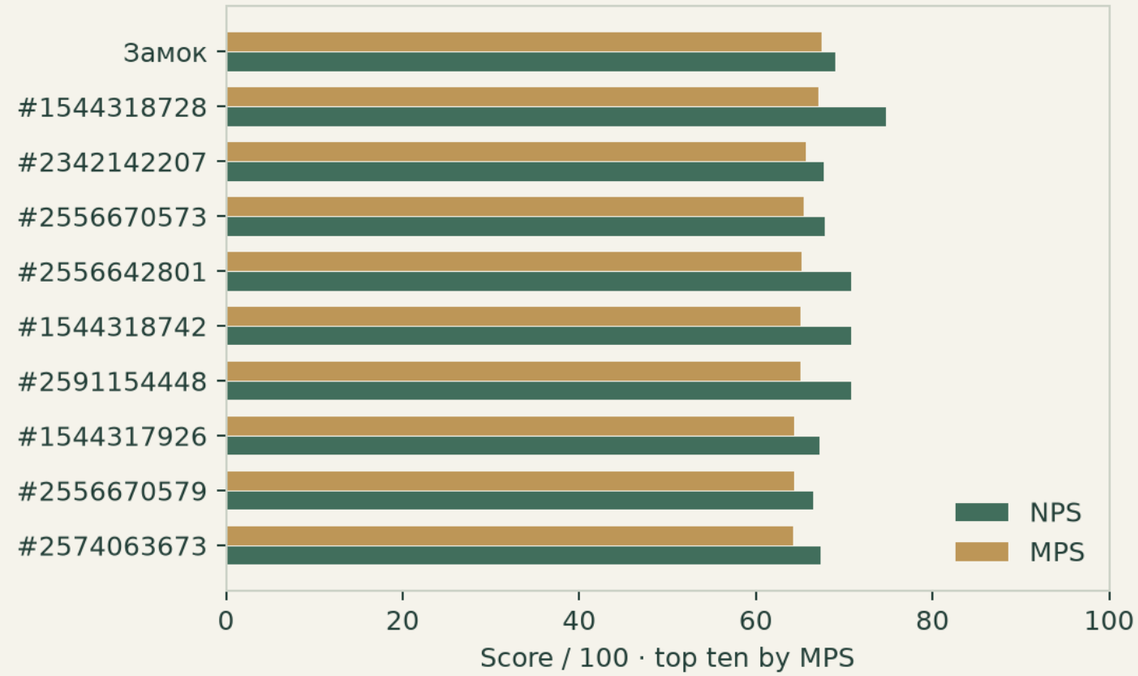
Horizon-only L: 70% visible coverage, 15% distance and 15% positive angular relief. All observers share the denominator of 15; self-observation is excluded. Program breadth is omitted because only one program is eligible.

Model: GDAL GVM_Edge; observer +1.7 m; target at DEM ground; Earth curvature with k=0.14286. Copernicus is a surface model. A feature on the skyline need not be a named summit; angular contrast is not topographic prominence.

The results, with room for doubt

Published weights are one interpretation. The explorer lets visitors build and download their own ranking.





A modest association, not a rule

Spearman ρ = 0.329; Pearson r = 0.338. Descriptive for a mapped, spatially dependent ≥1,800 m cohort. No causal claim or independent-sample significance test is made.

Special viewpoints: largest visible area 8,413.7 km² (node:2623072016); most visible peak proxies: Карақуш / Karakush, 629.

Explore the interactive map:

https://mmirshod.github.io/30daymapchallenge-2026/day05/

Weights change the answer

Zamok wins MPS with 20% or 30% landmark weight and with count-only L. At 10%, the NPS winner returns to first place. The NPS leaders are nearly tied; the ordering is not a universal aesthetic judgement.

Limits: 30 m surface terrain, incomplete OSM names, ground-cell targets, engine disagreement and subjective scoring. Radius is projected: some reported geodesic distances slightly exceed 100 km. Lakes and other excluded programs contribute nothing.